

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my interest in the Associate, Strategy Intern position in the Office of the Chief Technology Officer at Pearson. As a Ph.D. candidate, I bring a strong foundation in analytical modeling, data-driven strategy, and emerging technology. Moreover, I am excited to apply these skills at a company whose mission to make learning accessible to everyone deeply resonates with me.

Pearson has been among my top choices for an internship because of its unique position at the intersection of technology and education. As a researcher and course instructor, I have seen firsthand how the right tools and systems can transform learning outcomes. Pearson's commitment to using AI and innovation to bridge the global skills gap is exactly the kind of large-scale, meaningful challenge I want to contribute to.

My experience aligns well with what this role requires. Through my research, I have developed strong skills in strategic analysis, synthesizing complex information, and communicating findings clearly — having authored technical reports for the Minnesota Department of Transportation and presented at national conferences including INFORMS and TRB. As an Entrepreneurial Lead in the NSF I-Corps program, I led a cross-functional team through 100+ customer discovery interviews and managed a \$50K grant, giving me direct experience with business strategy, market validation, and working in fast-paced, ambiguous environments. My technical background in Python, data analysis, and optimization also positions me to contribute meaningfully to OCTO's work on AI strategy and operational improvement.

I would welcome the opportunity to bring my analytical mindset, curiosity about technology, and passion for learning to Pearson's OCTO team this summer. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Maziar Zamanpour